PHISHGUARD

Installation and User Acceptance Testing Guide

Direct-download Chrome extension installation and step-by-step system use

Current workflow: Download -> Extract -> Load unpacked -> Create/Sign in -> MFA -> Test protection features

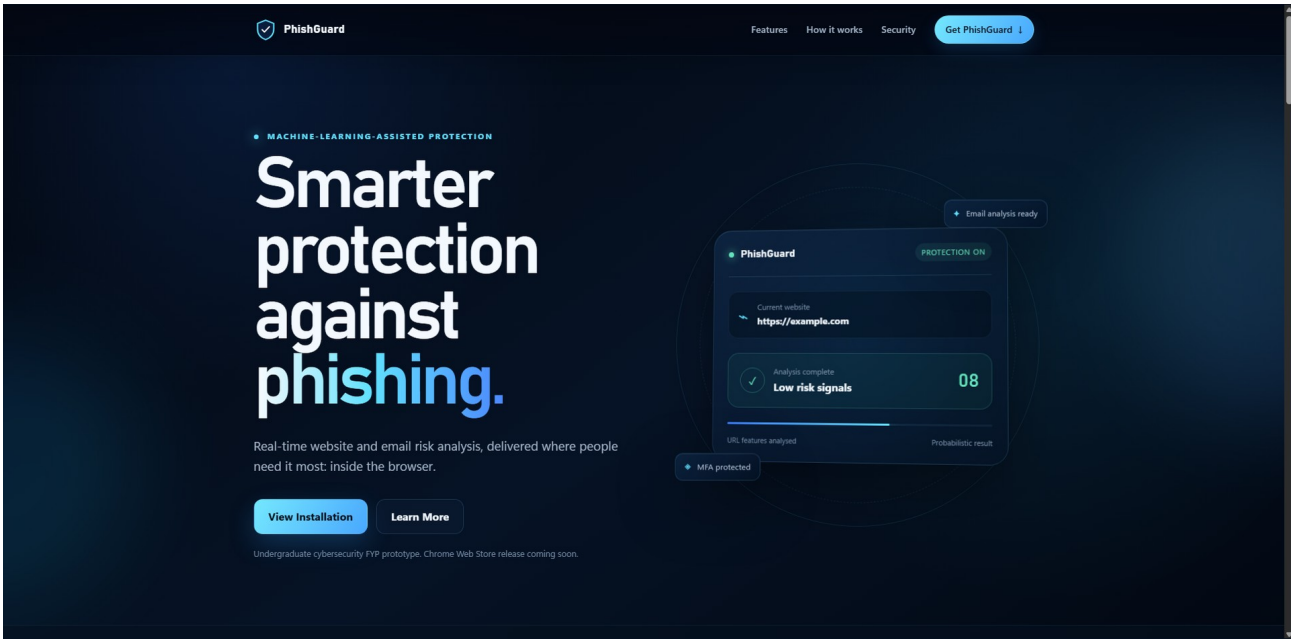
Important: The current PhishGuard build does not use a beta-access or activation code. Testers download the package, load the unpacked extension, and then create an account or sign in normally.

What you need before starting

- Google Chrome on the test computer.
- Internet access so the extension can reach the hosted PhishGuard backend.
- The PhishGuard website link provided by the developer.
- An authenticator application capable of generating TOTP codes (for example Google Authenticator or another compatible app).
- A test email account/Gmail account if the email-protection workflow will be tested.
- Only non-sensitive test credentials for Password Vault and phishing-related UAT tasks.

Step 1 - Open the PhishGuard website

Open the PhishGuard website using the link provided by the developer. The landing page introduces the website and email phishing-protection features. Select Get PhishGuard or View Installation to move to the installation section.



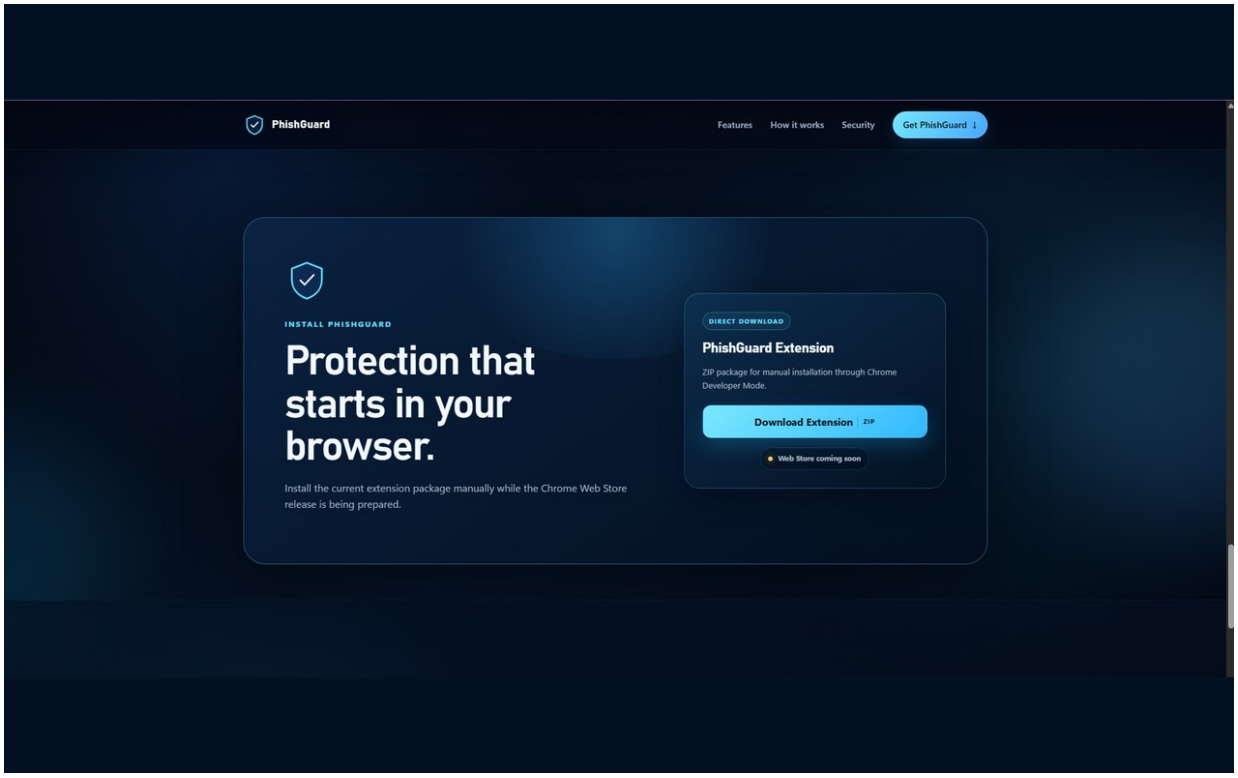
PhishGuard public website

Expected result

- The website loads correctly.
- The Get PhishGuard / View Installation controls are visible.
- No beta-access or activation-code form is shown.

Step 2 - Download the extension package

In the installation section, select Download Extension. Chrome downloads the current PhishGuard extension as a ZIP package. Save the ZIP somewhere easy to locate, such as the Downloads folder.



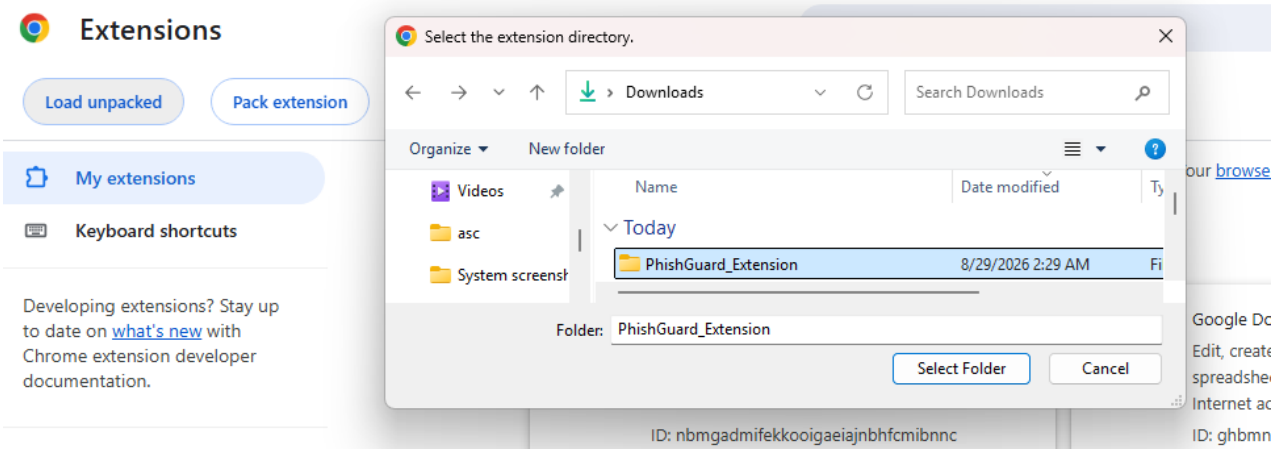
Direct-download installation section

After the download finishes

1. Open the Downloads folder.
2. Right-click the PhishGuard ZIP file and choose Extract All (or use another normal ZIP extraction method).
3. Keep the extracted PhishGuard_Extension folder in a location that will not be deleted during testing.

Step 3 - Load the unpacked extension in Chrome

4. In Chrome, enter chrome://extensions in the address bar.
5. Turn on Developer mode in the top-right area of the Extensions page.
6. Select Load unpacked.
7. When the folder-selection window appears, choose the extracted PhishGuard_Extension folder and select Select Folder.



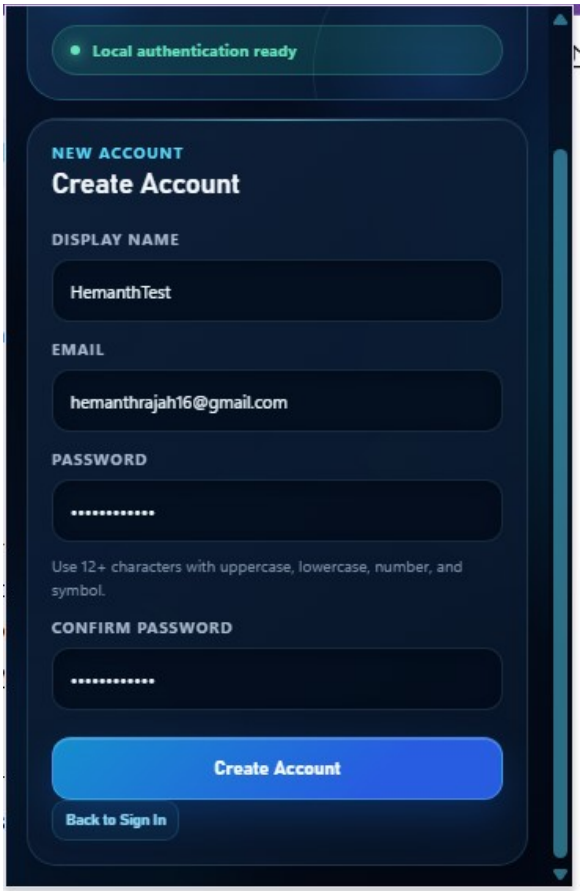
Select the extracted PhishGuard_Extension folder

Confirm installation

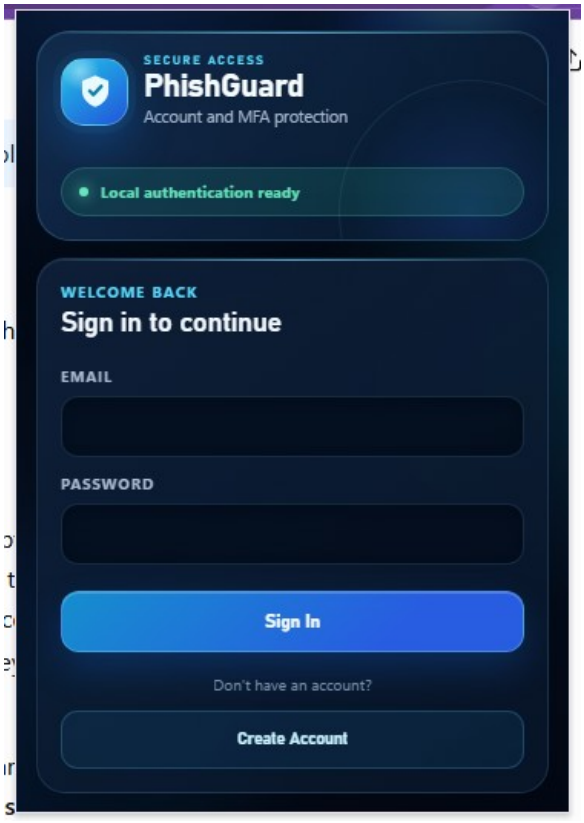
- PhishGuard appears on the Chrome Extensions page.
- Open the Chrome extensions (puzzle) menu and pin PhishGuard if you want quicker access during testing.
- Click the PhishGuard icon to open the popup.

Step 4 - Create an account or sign in

New testers should create an account first. Returning testers can use the Sign in page. The account password is for PhishGuard authentication and is separate from the Password Vault master password used later.



Create account



Sign in

For a new account

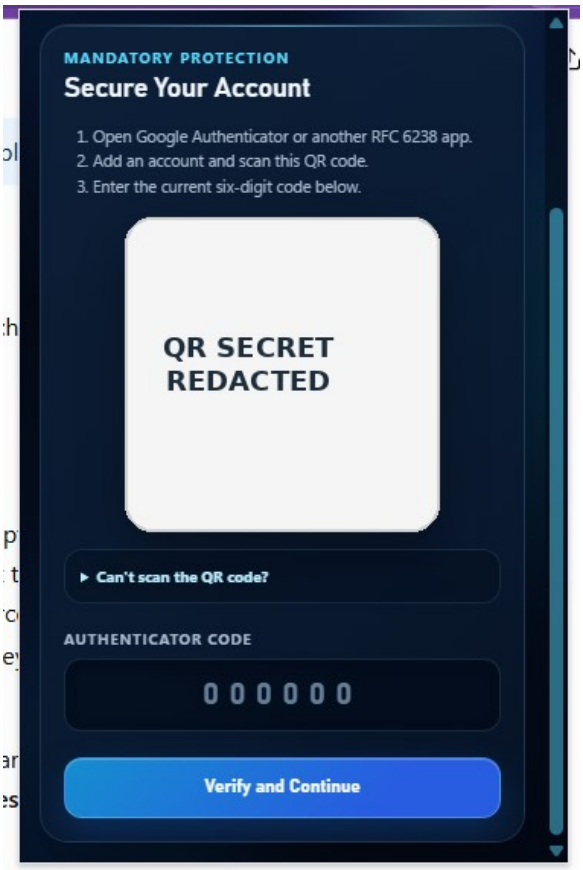
8. Open Create account.
9. Enter a display name, email address, and strong test password that satisfies the displayed requirements.
10. Submit the form. PhishGuard should move directly to MFA enrolment; there is no access-code field.

For an existing account

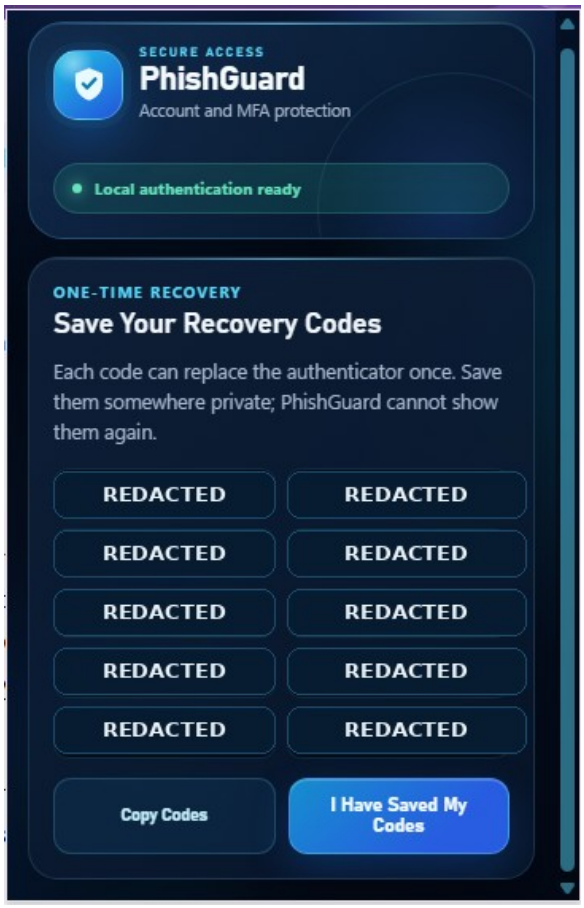
11. Enter the registered email address and account password.
12. Continue to the MFA verification step when the password is accepted.

Step 5 - Set up MFA and save recovery codes

MFA is mandatory for PhishGuard accounts. During first-time setup, scan the QR code with a compatible authenticator app and confirm the setup using the current TOTP code. The QR secret and recovery-code values in this guide are redacted for security.



MFA enrolment

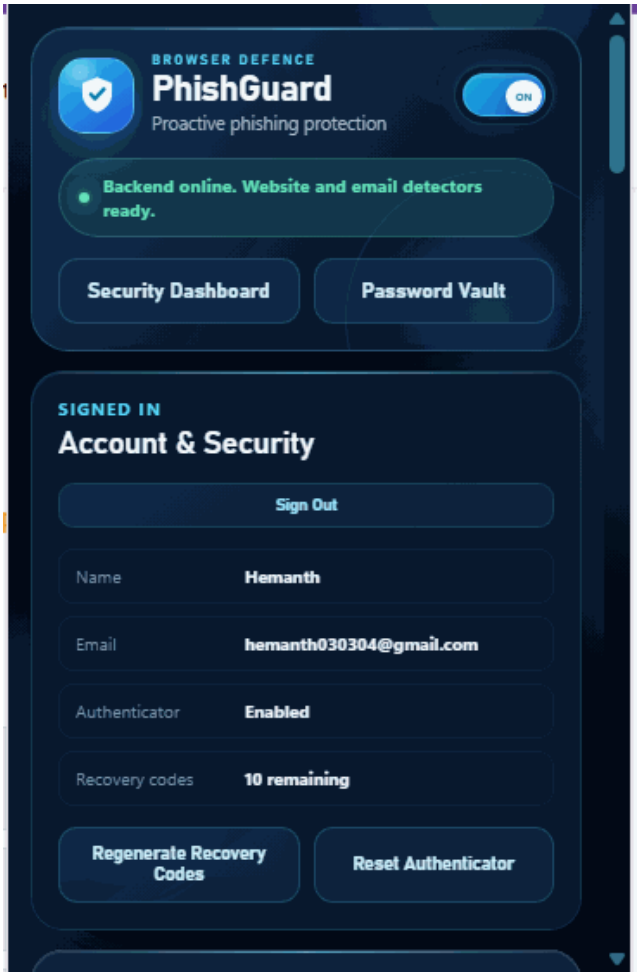


Recovery codes

13. Add PhishGuard to the authenticator application using the enrolment QR code.
14. Enter the current six-digit TOTP code into PhishGuard and confirm.
15. Save the recovery codes in a secure private location. Do not share them with other testers.
16. Continue into the authenticated extension.

Step 6 - Open the authenticated PhishGuard popup

After successful sign-in and MFA verification, the main popup becomes available. Check that protection is enabled and that the backend status reports that the website and email detectors are ready before running the UAT tasks.



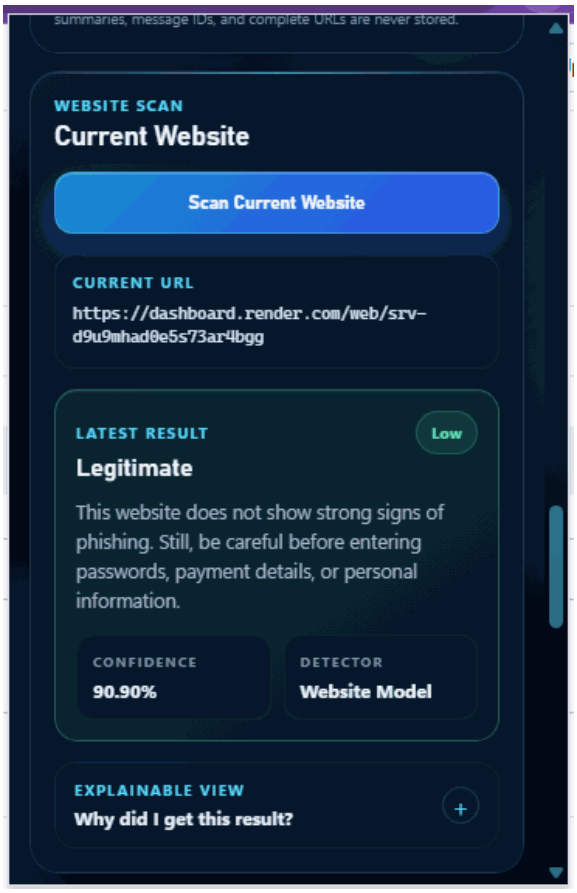
Authenticated PhishGuard popup

If the backend is not ready

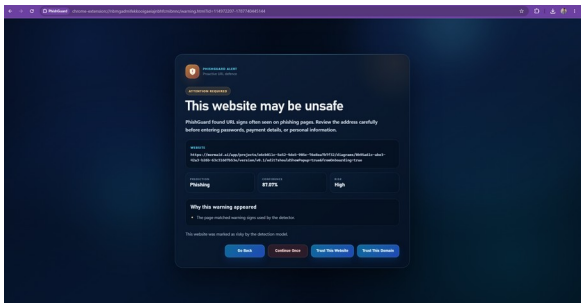
- Keep the computer connected to the internet.
- Close and reopen the popup after a short wait.
- If the status continues to show an unavailable backend, stop the UAT session and contact the developer rather than changing browser security settings.

Step 7 - Test automatic website protection

Open a normal HTTPS website first and review the Current Website result in the popup. PhishGuard should show the final risk and a short explanation. For the suspicious-site task, use only the controlled or sanitized fixture provided by the developer.



Current website result



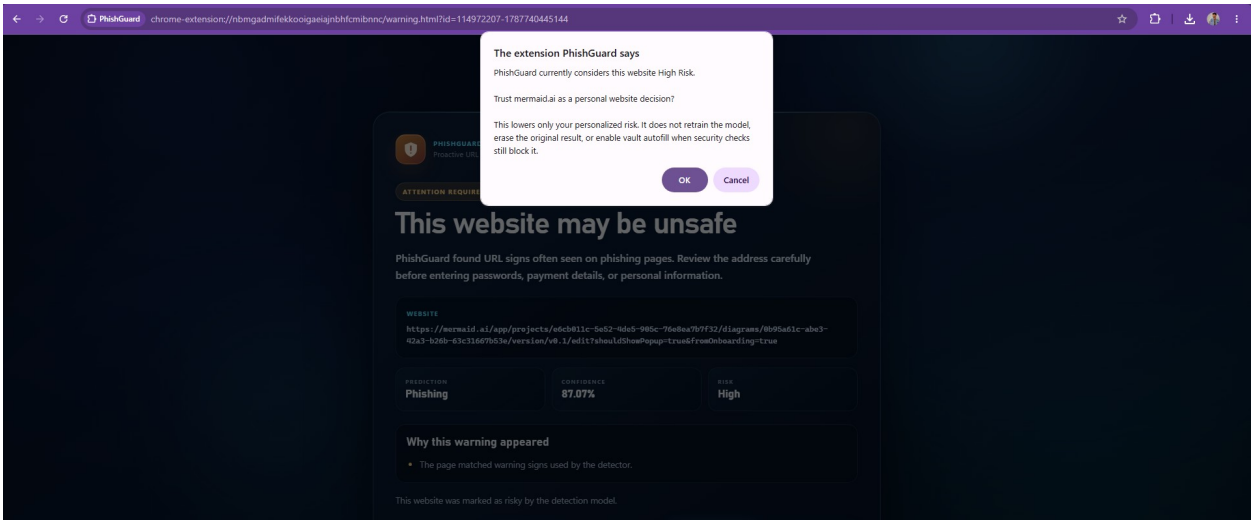
High-risk warning

What to test

- A legitimate HTTPS page should not be blocked unnecessarily.
- A controlled high-risk destination should trigger the dedicated warning page when it reaches the intervention threshold.
- Do not enter real credentials on any suspicious or controlled phishing test page.

Step 8 - Test Continue Once and personal website trust

The warning page provides separate actions so a one-time decision does not automatically become a permanent trust rule. Use the developer-provided controlled site for these actions.



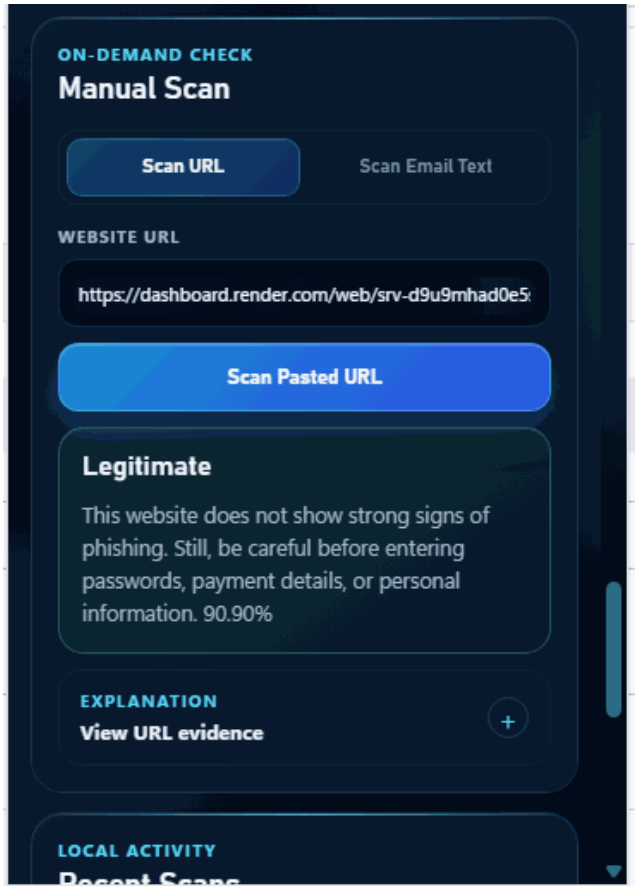
Persistent website trust confirmation

17. Select Continue Once and confirm that the current navigation can continue without permanently trusting the site.
18. Return to the controlled warning flow and choose the Trust Website option.
19. Confirm the persistent trust decision when prompted.
20. Later, remove the trust entry from the dashboard/settings and confirm normal risk handling returns.

Personal trust changes only the user-specific contextual handling. It does not retrain the website machine-learning model or erase strong security evidence.

Step 9 - Test Manual Scan and Gmail Email Protection

Manual Scan can be used when you want to check a URL before opening it. Paste a legitimate or controlled suspicious test URL into Manual Scan and compare the result wording with the automatic website workflow.



Manual website scan result

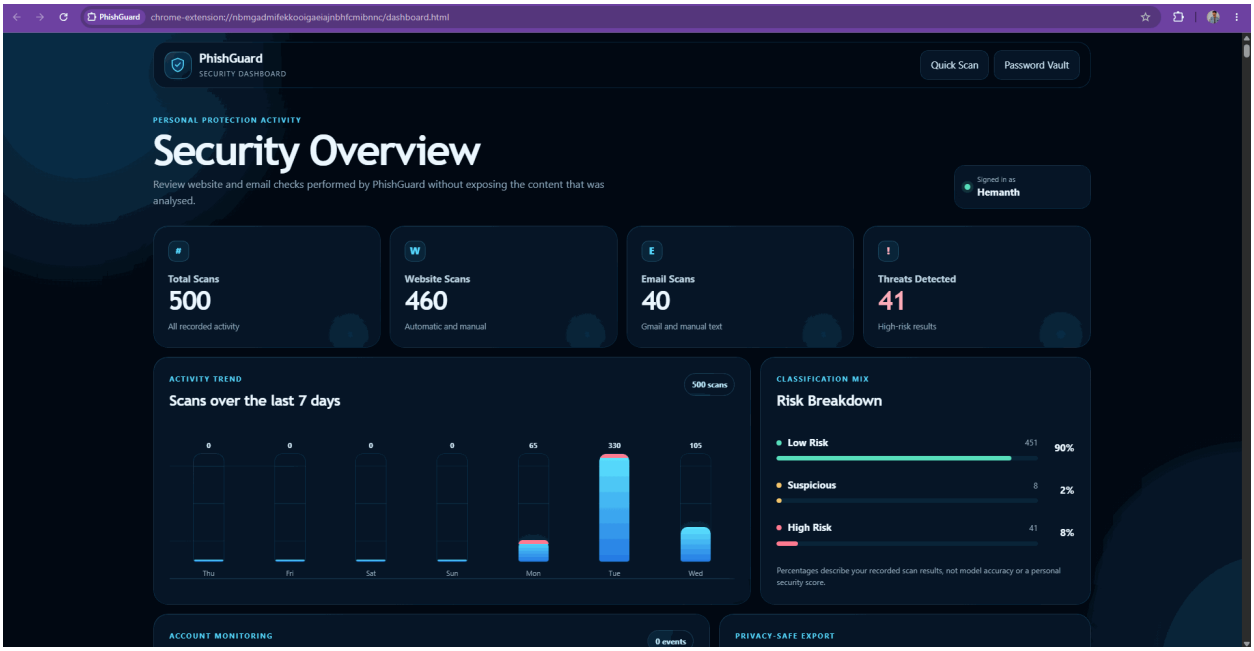
Gmail email test

21. Make sure Email Protection is enabled in PhishGuard.
22. Open Gmail in Chrome and open the legitimate test message provided by the developer.
23. Wait for the PhishGuard banner/summary to appear and review the risk explanation.
24. Dismiss the banner with X and confirm it stays dismissed for the current message view.
25. Open the controlled suspicious test email and confirm the summary changes for that message.
26. For the legitimate test sender, use the sender-trust control and review the personalized result.

If a banner does not appear, refresh Gmail once, reopen the message, and confirm that the PhishGuard extension is enabled. Do not test using live malicious email content.

Step 10 - Review the Security Dashboard and download reports

Open Security Dashboard from the authenticated popup. The dashboard is used to review recent scan activity, search or filter records, inspect detailed evidence, review security events and personal trust, and generate PDF security reports.



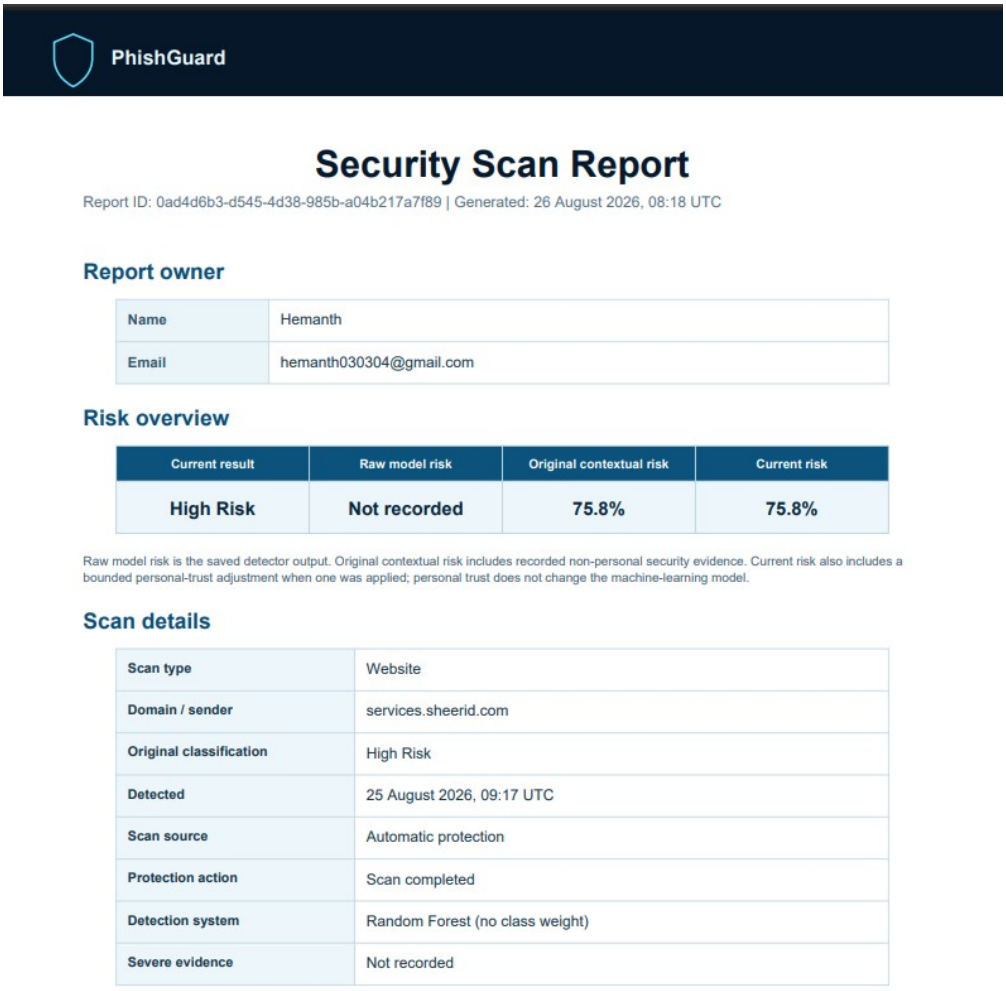
Security Dashboard overview

Report test

27. Open an individual scan record and review its details.
28. Download an individual scan report.
29. Download a valid date-range report such as Last 7 Days or a custom range.
30. Open the PDF and check that the owner, date/range, risk result, and explanation are readable.

Step 11 - Check a generated PDF report

A successful report download should open as a normal PDF and contain enough information for the tester to understand what was scanned and why the result was produced. The report should not contain reusable authentication secrets.



PhishGuard

Security Scan Report

Report ID: 0ad4d6b3-d545-4d38-985b-a04b217a7f89 | Generated: 26 August 2026, 08:18 UTC

Report owner

Name	Hemanth
Email	hemanth030304@gmail.com

Risk overview

Current result	Raw model risk	Original contextual risk	Current risk
High Risk	Not recorded	75.8%	75.8%

Raw model risk is the saved detector output. Original contextual risk includes recorded non-personal security evidence. Current risk also includes a bounded personal-trust adjustment when one was applied; personal trust does not change the machine-learning model.

Scan details

Scan type	Website
Domain / sender	services.sheerid.com
Original classification	High Risk
Detected	25 August 2026, 09:17 UTC
Scan source	Automatic protection
Protection action	Scan completed
Detection system	Random Forest (no class weight)
Severe evidence	Not recorded

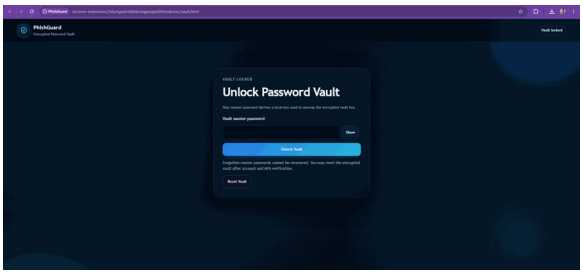
Example generated PhishGuard security report

Expected result

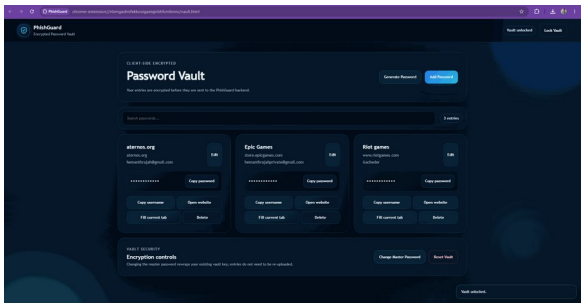
- The PDF opens without corruption.
- The selected scan or reporting period is correct.
- Risk and evidence information is readable.
- The report belongs to the signed-in test user.

Step 12 - Unlock and use the Password Vault

The Password Vault has its own master password and remains locked even when the main PhishGuard account is already signed in. For UAT, use only non-sensitive test credentials.



Vault unlock

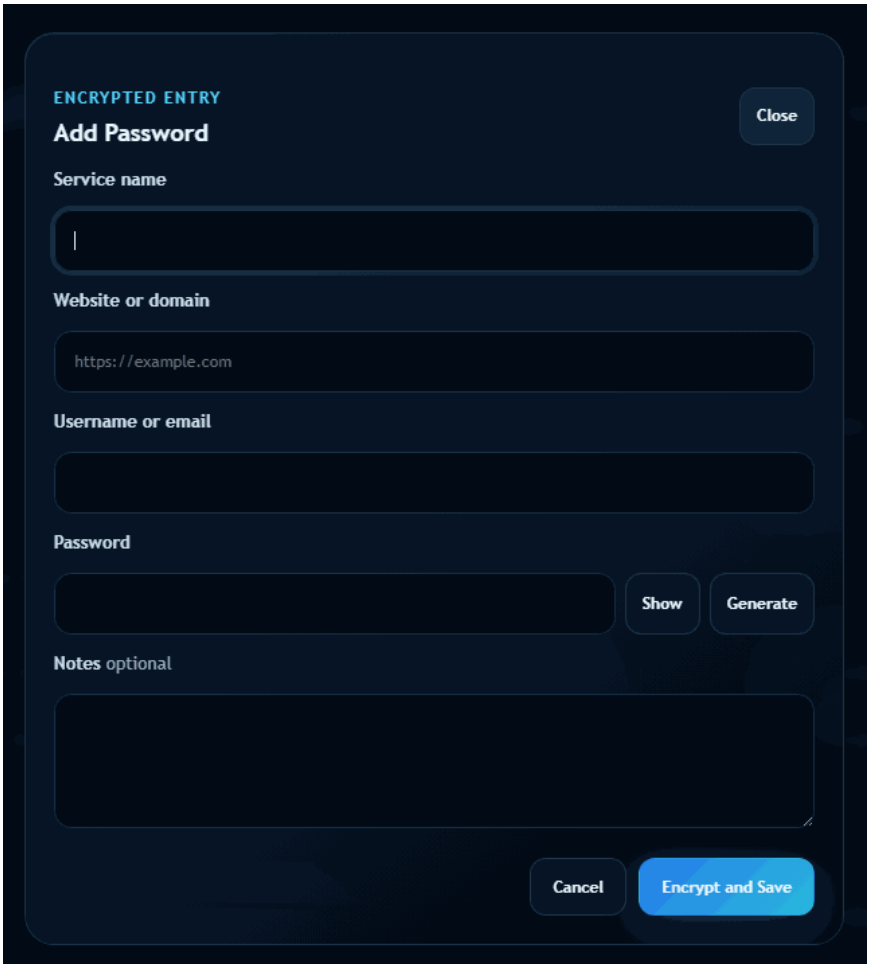


Vault dashboard

31. Open Password Vault from the popup.
32. Create or enter the test vault master password as instructed by the developer.
33. Unlock the vault and confirm saved entries are visible only after successful unlock.
34. Use the password generator for a controlled test login if required.
35. Lock the vault again and confirm decrypted entries are no longer available until it is unlocked again.

Step 13 - Add a test password and use Fill Current Tab

Add a non-sensitive credential for a controlled HTTPS login page. The browser encrypts the entry before it is stored by the backend. Saving and filling are separate decisions: a stored entry does not automatically mean PhishGuard will fill it into every page.



Add Password form

36. Enter the controlled website, test username, and test password, then save the entry.
37. Open the matching test website in another Chrome tab.
38. Return to the vault and select Fill Current Tab.
39. Confirm PhishGuard selects the matching web tab and fills only when destination checks allow it.
40. On a controlled risky destination, confirm automatic credential filling remains restricted according to the security policy.

Step 14 - Finish the UAT session

41. Review any remaining settings or trust entries used during the test.
42. Remove temporary personal trust entries if the developer asks you to leave the account clean.
43. Delete any non-sensitive vault test entry that is no longer required.
44. Log out of PhishGuard.
45. Complete your individual UAT form based on what you personally observed. If any pre-marked Pass result did not match your experience, change it to Fail and explain the issue.
46. Complete the usability ratings, overall acceptance decision, comments, and tester confirmation yourself.

Testing safety

- Use only controlled or sanitized phishing fixtures supplied for the project.
- Never enter real banking, university, work, or personal credentials into suspicious test pages.
- Do not share MFA QR codes, live authenticator codes, recovery codes, passwords, or Password Vault master passwords in screenshots or feedback forms.

Quick troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
Extension does not appear	Return to chrome://extensions and confirm the extracted PhishGuard_Extension folder was selected with Load unpacked.
Backend shows offline	Check internet access, wait briefly, then reopen the popup. If it remains unavailable, contact the developer.
MFA code rejected	Confirm the authenticator entry is PhishGuard, use the current code before it expires, and ensure the computer/phone time is correct.
Gmail banner does not appear	Confirm Email Protection is enabled, refresh Gmail once, and reopen the test message.
Report does not download	Confirm you are signed in, use a valid owned scan/date range, and retry from Security Dashboard.
Vault will not fill	Confirm the vault is unlocked and the matching controlled HTTPS site is open in a normal web tab.